

Digital Literacy - Vityarthi Project

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Introduction

In today's digital age, having strong digital literacy skills is essential for students to succeed academically and professionally. This project focuses on developing awareness and practical knowledge about various aspects of digital literacy, including creating professional online profiles, using coding and collaboration platforms, practicing proper email etiquette, and understanding cybercrime and online safety. As a student Digital Ambassador, the aim of this project is to build a comprehensive digital portfolio and help others navigate the online world safely and effectively. Through this project, I explored platforms like GitHub, LinkedIn, HackerRank, and Google Workspace, which are important for skill development and professional growth. Additionally, I studied cybercrime scenarios such as UPI and online payment fraud to understand potential risks and preventive measures. This project has helped me become more aware, responsible, and confident in using digital tools for my academic and future career goals.

Digital Literacy - Task 1 Project Report

This design is a presentation called "Navigating the Digital Frontier" using Canva. I picked Canva because it has professional templates and is easy to use, which helped me focus on what to say and how to show it without needing to know a lot about graphic design.

The design is three important things for being digital citizens:

- * what digital literacy means
- * how to stay safe
- * How to write professional emails.

I used orange and black with a style to get peoples attention and keep things organized. I broke each section into small easy-to-understand parts with explanations to make complex ideas like being skeptical online.

One thing I found interesting while designing was balancing looks with readability.

The grungy style looks modern and cool for a digital ambassador role

I had to choose the right font and spacing so that the advice stayed the main focus.

Trying out visuals to show ideas like "digital skepticism" made me see how much design affects how people receive information.

I used Canva to make "Navigating the Digital Frontier".

The digital literacy is very important.

Digital safety practices are also very important.

Professional email etiquette is very important.

I made sure to design it

The design helps people understand citizenship.

The visual presentation looks great.
I am happy, with how it turned out.

Digital Literacy - Task 2 - Portfolio

For my academic and professional development, I have chosen three important platforms: GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. These platforms will help me develop my technical skills, build a professional network, and showcase my work to future employers over the next four years.

GitHub is a platform used for storing, managing, and sharing coding projects. I plan to use GitHub to upload my programming projects, machine learning models, and other technical assignments. By the end of four years, I aim to build a strong portfolio that demonstrates my coding abilities and problem-solving skills.

LinkedIn is a professional networking platform that helps students and professionals connect with industry experts and companies. I will use LinkedIn to share my achievements, certifications, and project updates. I also plan to connect with professionals, join technical communities, and explore internship and job opportunities through LinkedIn.

Kaggle is a platform mainly used for data science and machine learning practice. I will use Kaggle to work with real-world datasets, participate in competitions, and improve my data analysis and machine learning skills.

Over the next four years, I plan to stay active on these platforms, continuously improve my skills, and build a strong professional profile for my future career and MBA goals.

Digital Literacy - Task -3 -Platforms

For this project, I used HackerRank and Google Workspace tools to develop my technical and digital collaboration skills. I created an account on HackerRank and completed a beginner-level programming challenge.

HackerRank is a platform that helps students practice programming, improve logical thinking, and prepare for coding interviews. By solving beginner problems, I was able to understand basic programming concepts such as input/output, problem-solving techniques, and code implementation. I plan to continue practicing on HackerRank regularly to improve my coding skills over the next four years, which will help me in my B.Tech studies, internships, and placement preparation.

In addition, I used Google Forms to create a Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz for my classmates. The quiz included five questions, such as multiple-choice and short-answer questions. The responses were automatically recorded in Google Sheets, which made it easy to organize and analyze the data. This helped me understand how online collaboration tools work.

Overall, these platforms will help me academically by improving my programming knowledge, problem-solving skills, data collection skills, and digital literacy, which are very important for my academic and professional growth.

Digital Literacy - Task - 4 -Email Etiquette

Poor digital communication can lead to misunderstandings, mistakes, and serious academic or professional problems. One realistic situation could be a college group project where the team leader created a WhatsApp group to coordinate the project work. The leader sent a message saying, “Everyone submit your part by tomorrow,” but did not mention the exact submission time, file format, file name, or where the files should be submitted. Some students thought the deadline was midnight, while others thought it was during class hours the next day. One student submitted the work in PDF format, another submitted in Word format, and another student named the file incorrectly. One member even sent the file to the wrong email address. Because of this confusion, the team leader was unable to compile and edit the final report on time, and the group submitted the assignment late. As a result, the whole group lost marks even though everyone had completed their individual work.

This problem became bigger because there was no proper communication platform, no clear instructions, and no confirmation from team members. Some members also did not check messages regularly, which caused further delay. Time was wasted in correcting file formats and collecting all files again.

This problem could have been avoided if the communication had been clear, detailed, and professional. The team leader should have clearly mentioned the exact deadline time, submission method, file format, file naming format, and instructions in a proper message or email. The leader should have also asked for confirmation from all team members and sent reminders before the deadline. Using tools like Google Drive or Google Classroom would have made file collection easier and more organized.

This situation shows that effective digital communication is very important for teamwork, time management, and successful completion of academic work.

Digital Literacy - Task - 5 - Cyber Crime

While researching UPI and online payment fraud, I was surprised to learn that most cybercrimes do not involve advanced hacking, but instead rely on social engineering techniques to trick users. Fraudsters often create a sense of urgency or trust by pretending to be bank officials, customer care agents, or even known contacts. They use methods such as fake payment requests, phishing links, and QR codes to mislead users into entering their UPI PIN or OTP. I was also surprised to see that even educated individuals and college students fall victim to these scams due to lack of awareness or carelessness.

Another important realization was how quickly money can be transferred and how difficult it can be to recover once the transaction is completed. I also learned about the importance of immediate reporting through the National Cyber Crime Portal and helpline 1930.

As a result, I will change my habits by always verifying payment requests, avoiding unknown links, regularly checking app permissions, and staying updated about new fraud techniques. This research has made me more aware, cautious, and responsible while using digital payment systems.

Conclusion

This Digital Literacy project helped me understand the importance of using digital tools in a responsible and professional way. Through this project, I learned how to create and manage professional profiles on platforms like GitHub and LinkedIn, practice coding on HackerRank, and use Google Forms for collaboration and data collection. I also learned how to write professional emails and follow proper online communication etiquette. One of the most important parts of this project was learning about cybercrime, especially UPI and online fraud, and how to stay safe online. Overall, this project improved my technical skills, communication skills, and digital awareness, which will help me in my academic journey, future career, and professional development.

References

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